

SPROLL 03

Play It Again



a record you can follow

The Sproll Curriculum · Cycle I: Pops

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Cycle I — Pops: Things, Differences, and Counting

Sproll 03 of 40 · follows Sproll 02: What Happened First?

[Illustration: the two-line ledger strip from Sproll 02, shown alone, large and clear: circle, then triangle]



[Illustration: the same ledger strip, with a small curious arrow pointing from it toward an empty space on the page, as if inviting the reader to build what it describes]

 Can you follow it?

[Illustration: a fresh field of three shapes with the circle bold and chosen, matching the ledger's first entry]



[Illustration: the circle now settled, with a new bold triangle chosen beside it, matching the ledger's second entry]

○ ▲ Then: Pop the triangle.

[Illustration: the circle and triangle sitting together, plain and settled]



[Illustration: the freshly built picture beside the original picture from Sproll 02, drawn identically, with a small equals sign between them]



Yes.

[Illustration: the ledger strip once more, alone, as if presented for a second try]



[Illustration: a completely fresh field, circle bold and chosen, exactly as before]



[Illustration: the circle settled, triangle now bold and chosen]

○ ▲ Then: Pop the triangle.

[Illustration: the circle and triangle together once more, identical to page 7]



[Illustration: the ledger strip small in the corner, with three little copies of the circle-and-triangle result fanned out beside it, all identical]



Follow the same record.

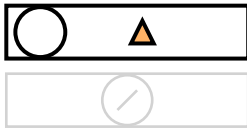
Build the same thing.
Every time.

[Illustration: a small open eye or magnifying glass beside the ledger strip, suggesting checking rather than guessing]

 You don't have to guess.

You can check.

[Illustration: the ledger strip, with a faint third line beneath it, empty except for a small shape drawn very lightly, almost a ghost, with a small line through it]



But what if a record could say:

not this way?

— turn the page for Sproll 04: Not This Way —

A Note for Grown-Ups

This book introduces replay: following a kept record, step by step, to rebuild what it describes, rather than only reading it. The record used throughout is the ledger strip introduced in Sproll 02.

The claim this book asks a child to test for themselves, by literally doing it twice, is that a complete record, followed exactly, gives back the same result every time. This is not a simplification. It is the same guarantee that makes a recipe trustworthy or a set of instructions worth following, and it is given a precise formal treatment (a determinism proposition) in the technical companion material for this curriculum.

Page 15 closes on a deliberately unresolved image: a faint, crossed-out shape in a third ledger line. This anticipates Sproll 04, which asks whether a record can describe something that was considered and specifically not chosen, and whether that is different from simply leaving it out of the record altogether.

Sproll 04: Not This Way continues directly from this book's final page.